

Wednesday, 8 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Clear

31° 21°

BIRMINGHAM

Partly cloudy

30° 18°

MANCHESTER

Partly cloudy

27° 17°

GLASGOW

Overcast

22° 15°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **One million more UK homeowners are facing higher mortgage payments over the next two years, adding an average of £45 a month to their bills.**

This comes as homeowners move onto new deals, with experts predicting a significant financial squeeze for many families. The increase could impact household budgets across the country.

ECONOMY · UK

- 2 **A murder inquiry has been launched after a mother and her two children were tragically found dead at a property.**

Police have confirmed the discovery and are investigating the circumstances surrounding their deaths. The community has been left in shock by the devastating news.

CRIME · UK

- 3 **MI5 knew one of its agents was a misogynist obsessed with violence, according to a secret inquiry by the security service's watchdog.**

The inquiry found 'serious failings' in MI5's management of 'Agent X'. This raises serious questions about oversight and vetting within the security services.

SECURITY · UK

- 4 **A teacher 'feared she would die' after being stabbed in the head by a pupil, a court has heard.**

The jury was told the 16-year-old attacked her with a large kitchen knife. The incident has sent shockwaves through the education community.

CRIME · UK

- 5 **Prince Harry has lost his High Court privacy case against the publisher of the Daily Mail.**

The judge, Mr Justice Nicklin, ruled that the claimants had failed to prove their allegations. This marks a significant legal setback for the Duke of Sussex.

ROYALS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Brighton-born Patrice Lawrence has been named the new children's laureate, representing children's literature until 2028.**
She will be a key figure promoting reading and books for young people across the UK. It's a fantastic recognition of her work and influence.
ON AIR – What were your favourite books as a child? Did a children's laureate inspire you?
LITERATURE · FUTURE
- 2 Harry Styles has officially received a Guinness World Record for the longest run of shows at Wembley Stadium.**
The 'Watermelon Sugar' singer is the first artist to perform 12 shows on a single tour at the iconic venue. It's a huge achievement for the British star.
ON AIR – Have you ever been to a Harry Styles concert? What's the most shows you've seen an artist play?
MUSIC · RECENT
- 3 Russell T Davies is teasing a new TV project, though he admits he 'doesn't know if it works' yet.**
The Swansea-born screenwriter is known for his groundbreaking work on shows like 'Doctor Who' and 'It's a Sin'. We can't wait to see what he comes up with next.
ON AIR – What kind of show do you hope Russell T Davies is working on? What's your favourite of his past projects?
TELEVISION · FUTURE
- 4 ITV hits like 'I'm a Celebrity' are set to remain free to watch after Sky announced it is buying ITV's media and entertainment divisions.**
The £1.6 billion deal means popular shows will still be accessible to everyone. It's good news for viewers who love their favourite ITV programmes.
ON AIR – Which ITV shows are you glad will remain free to watch? What do you think of Sky's takeover?
TELEVISION · FUTURE
- 5 YouTuber KSI shocked fans over the weekend by announcing his departure from the Sidemen.**
This news has left many wondering what's next for the hugely popular content creator and the rest of the group. It's a big change for the online world.
ON AIR – Are you a fan of KSI or the Sidemen? What do you think this means for their future projects?
ONLINE · RECENT

On the schedule

1 **Coco Gauff has battled through to her first Wimbledon semi-final after a comeback victory over fellow American Jessica Pegula.**

The young star fought back from a set down to secure her place. It's a huge moment for Gauff as she continues her impressive run at the tournament.

ON AIR – Can Coco Gauff go all the way and win Wimbledon this year? What a performance!

TENNIS · UK

2 **Jannik Sinner has moved a step closer to defending his Wimbledon title with a victory over Germany's Jan-Lennard Struff.**

Sinner is now through to the semi-finals, looking strong in his bid to retain the trophy. He's certainly showing why he's the defending champion.

ON AIR – Who do you think will win the men's singles title at Wimbledon this year? Is Sinner unstoppable?

TENNIS · UK

3 **A peak audience of 9.1 million tuned in overnight to watch England beat Mexico and reach the World Cup quarter-finals.**

It was an epic win that captivated the nation, with huge numbers watching the dramatic match. The excitement for the tournament is clearly building!

ON AIR – Were you one of the millions watching England's big win? How far do you think they can go?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Tempers flared in Wimbledon's mixed doubles as Jelena Ostapenko and Marcelo Arevalo advanced to the semi-finals.**

Their victory was marred by a fiery post-match argument, adding some unexpected drama to the court. It certainly got people talking!

ON AIR – What do you make of the drama on the court? Is it part of the game or does it go too far?

TENNIS · UK

5 **England has called up Harlequins forward Chandler Cunningham-South to replace injured wing Cadan Murley for Saturday's Nations Championship game against Fiji.**

It's a change to the squad ahead of a big international fixture. Cunningham-South will be hoping to make an impact.

ON AIR – Are you looking forward to England's match against Fiji this weekend? Who are you hoping to see perform?

RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that listening to the gentle hum of a washing machine can be surprisingly calming for some.**
Researchers found that the rhythmic, low-frequency sounds can create a sense of comfort and help with relaxation, almost like a domestic white noise machine.
- 2 The trend of 'urban foraging' is gaining popularity, with city dwellers discovering edible plants in unexpected places.**
From wild garlic in parks to berries on common land, people are enjoying the adventure of finding free, fresh ingredients close to home.
- 3 Experts are noting a rise in popularity for 'vintage fountain pens' as a mindful alternative to digital note-taking.**
The smooth flow of ink and the deliberate act of writing are providing a tactile and satisfying experience for many in an increasingly digital world.
- 4 New research highlights the mood-boosting benefits of 'watching a captivating sunset' on a regular basis.**
Scientists suggest that taking time to observe the natural beauty of a sunset can reduce stress and promote feelings of well-being.
- 5 The art of 'patchwork quilting' is making a significant comeback, with many finding joy in creating unique fabric designs.**
It's a wonderful way to repurpose old materials and connect with a traditional craft, often resulting in beautiful, heirloom pieces.
- 6 A growing number of people are embracing 'reading physical maps' again for planning journeys and exploring new areas.**
There's a certain satisfaction in unfolding a large map and tracing routes, offering a different perspective than a screen-based navigation.
- 7 Scientists have found that looking at 'clouds' and identifying shapes can significantly reduce stress levels.**
This simple, age-old pastime encourages mindfulness and offers a gentle distraction from daily worries, promoting a sense of calm.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we hear our favourite song come on the radio, even if we're in public?

ANSWER: A LITTLE BIT OF 'AIR DRUMMING' OR 'AIR GUITAR' – JUST A SUBTLE MOVEMENT, MIND!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'spot' on the sofa that they absolutely have to sit in for their evening telly. What's special about it?

ANSWER: IT'S 'THE PERFECT ANGLE' FOR VIEWING, OR IT'S 'JUST THE RIGHT SQUISHINESS'!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you rediscover an 'old childhood toy' that you thought was long gone, and it brings back a flood of memories?

What was that special toy for you, and what memories does it bring back when you see it now?

- We all have those 'unusual snacks' that we secretly love but might not admit to readily. Perhaps a funny combination or something a bit retro?

What's your guilty pleasure snack, and what makes it so appealing to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is called a parliament?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of hedgehogs is called a prickle, because of their spines?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Honey never spoils and can be safe to eat even after thousands of years.
- The Great Wall of China is not visible from space with the naked eye.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- Bananas are technically berries, but strawberries are not.
- The strongest muscle in the human body is the masseter, which is the jaw muscle.
- There are more possible permutations of a deck of 52 playing cards than there are atoms on Earth.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, allowing them to 'taste' host plants before laying eggs.
- The world's quietest room is located at Microsoft's headquarters in Washington state.

On this day

Day 189 of the year, 176 days left in 2026. Today Christian Feast Day: Abda and Sabas; Christian Feast Day: Auspicius of Trier; Christian Feast Day: Grimbald; Christian Feast Day: Landrada. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1935 — Steve Lawrence, American actor and singer (died 2024)
- 1947 — Kim Darby, American actress
- 1923 — Val Bettin, American actor (died 2021)
- 1944 — Jaimoe, American drummer
- 1940 — Joe B. Mauldin, American bass player and songwriter (died 2015)
- 1980 — Robbie Keane, Irish footballer
- 1998 — Jaden Smith, American actor and rapper
- 1961 — Andrew Fletcher, English keyboard player (died 2022)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1912 — Henrique Mitchell de Paiva Couceiro leads an unsuccessful royalist attack against the First Portuguese Republic in Chaves.
- 1982 — A failed assassination attempt against Iraqi president Saddam Hussein results in the Dujail Massacre over the next several months.
- 1968 — The Chrysler wildcat strike begins in Detroit, Michigan.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1988 — The Island Express train travelling from Bangalore to Kanyakumari derails on the Peruman bridge and falls into Ashtamudi Lake, Kerala in India killing 105 passengers and injuring over 200 more.
- 1970 — Richard Nixon delivers a special congressional message enunciating Native American self-determination as official US Indian policy, leading to the Indian Self-Determination and Education Assistance Act of 1975.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1912 — Henrique Mitchell de Paiva Couceiro leads an unsuccessful royalist attack against the First Portuguese Republic in Chaves.
- 1966 — King Mwambutsa IV Bangiriceng of Burundi is deposed by his son Prince Charles Ndizi.

- 1994 — Space Shuttle Columbia is launched on an international science mission.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 190 of the year, 175 days left in 2026. Today Arbor Day (Cambodia); Christian Feast Day: Amandina of Schakkebroek (one of Martyrs of Southern Hunan); Christian Feast Day: Blessed Marija Petković; Christian Feast Day: Everilda. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1965 — Frank Bello, American bass player
- 1951 — Chris Cooper, American actor
- 1972 — Ara Babajian, American drummer and songwriter
- 1957 — Paul Merton, English comedian, actor, and screenwriter
- 1987 — Rebecca Sugar, American animator, composer, and screenwriter
- 1956 — Tom Hanks, American actor, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1974 — Gary Kelly, Irish footballer
- 1986 — Kiely Williams, American singer-songwriter and dancer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1979 — A car bomb destroys a Renault motor car owned by "Nazi hunters" Serge and Beate Klarsfeld outside their home in France in an unsuccessful assassination attempt.
- 1955 — The Russell–Einstein Manifesto calls for a reduction of the risk of nuclear warfare.
- 1962 — Starfish Prime tests the effects of a nuclear explosion at orbital altitudes.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

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Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026		AUGUST 2026	
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn	FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off	FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU	FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day	FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome
SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites		
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot		
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2		
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)		
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW			
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller		
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)		

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)